

Our topic today is the class of answers to the survival question which make reference to immaterial souls. There were four of these:

A large, solid red circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the words "soul" and "survival" are written in a white, bold, sans-serif font, stacked vertically.

**soul
survival**

P

+

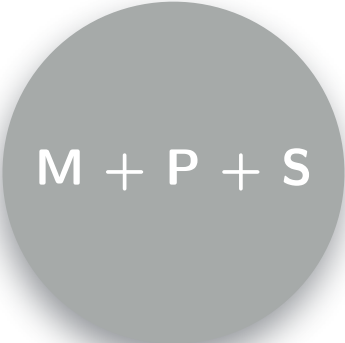
S

These theories are importantly different. But they have one thing in common: all are false if there are no such things as immaterial souls.

M

+

S



M + P + S

Last time we discussed some reasons to think that we should not believe in the existence of immaterial souls unless we have a good argument that they exist.

The argument we are going to look at turns on the idea that immaterial souls are needed to explain the nature of **consciousness.**

1. We have no sensory experience of immaterial souls.
2. It is not self-evident that there are immaterial souls.
3. We have no good argument for the existence of immaterial souls.
4. If P is not self-evident and your senses don't tell you that P and you don't have a good argument for P, you should not believe P.

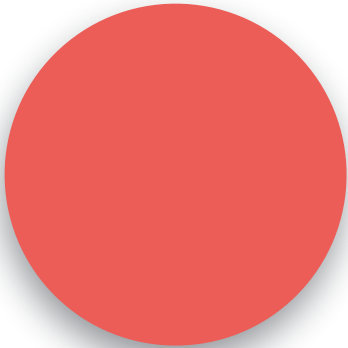
C. You should not believe in the existence of immaterial souls.
(1,2,3,4)

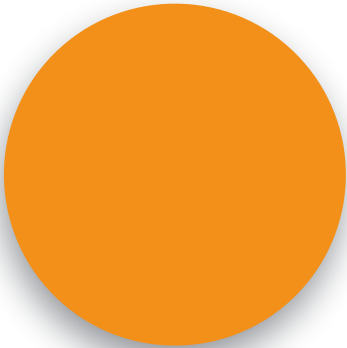
THE EVIDENTIALIST ARGUMENT AGAINST BELIEF IN IMMATERIAL SOULS

question which make reference to immaterial souls. There

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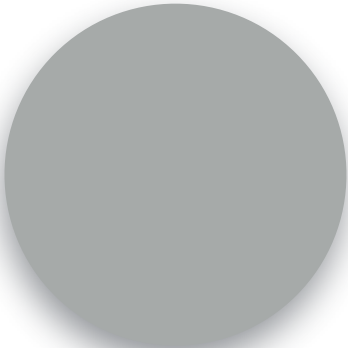




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Least time we discussed in the past think that we should not

believe in the existence of immaterial souls unless we have a good

argument that they exist.

The argument we are going to



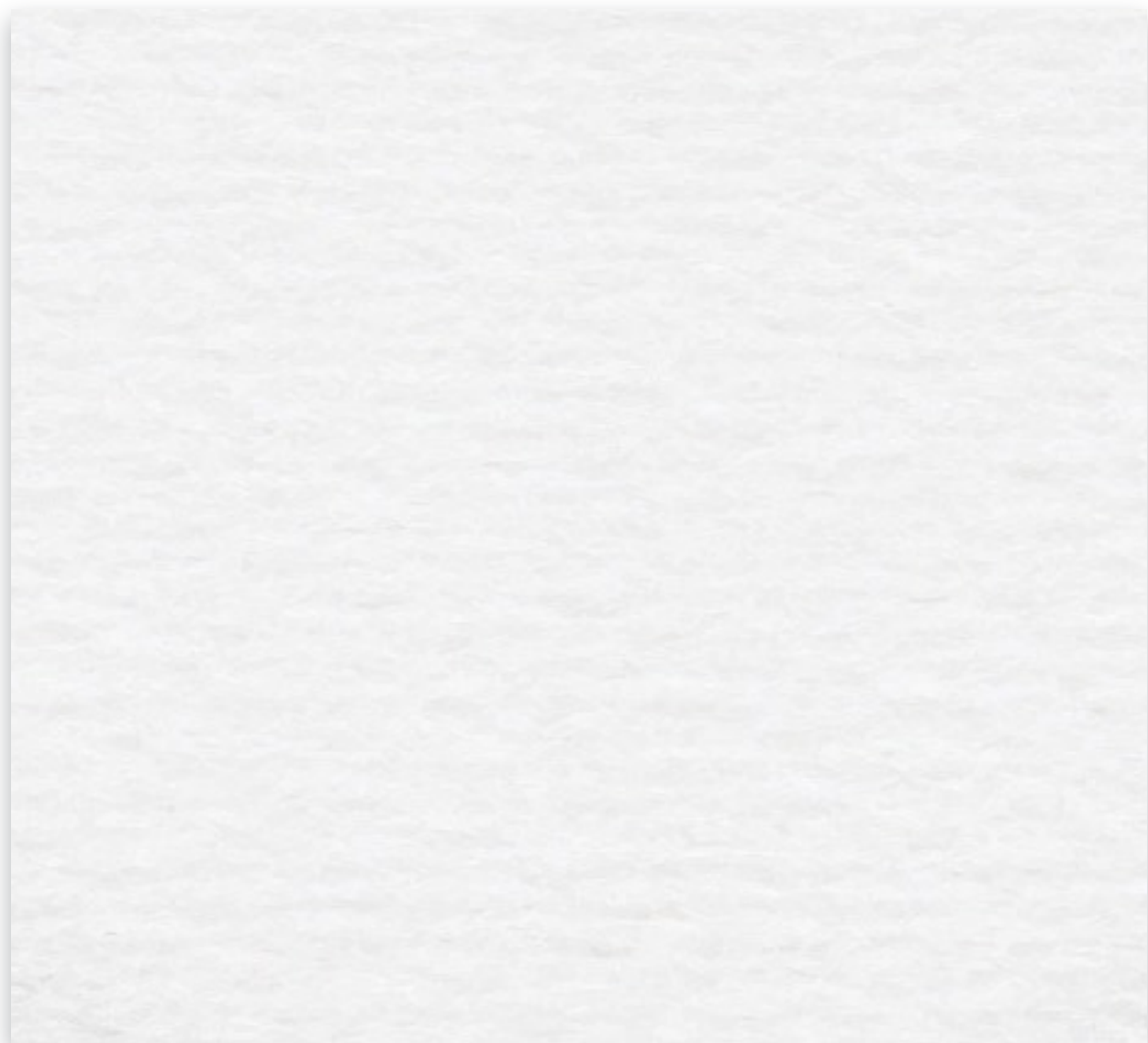
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consciousness.

■ ■
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SQLS.

existentialism.

1. We have no sensory experience

And you don't have a good

2. It is not self-evident that

4. If P is not self-evident and

3. We have no good argument for

C. You should not believe in the

there are infants:

do i i over P.

officiaries:

argument for P , you should not

the existence of initial

(1, 2, 3, 4)



your senses don't tell you that



we are (either wholly or in part) immaterial things.

Our topic today is the believer in material souls view that

You may recall that we came up with two believers in

in materialism answers to the identity question:

A large blue circle with a white drop shadow, containing the text "Simple dualism: I am an immaterial soul" in white. The text is centered and arranged in four lines.

**Simple
dualism: I am
an immaterial
soul**

A solid blue circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is centered and reads: "Fusion dualism: I am a combination of a soul and a body".

Fusion
dualism: I am
a combination
of a soul
and a body

**Soul
survival:**

X is me just in
case X is the
same immaterial
soul as me

Fusion survival:

X is me just in case X
has the same immaterial
soul as me and is the
same material thing as
me

For right now we're going to set aside the question of which

of these views is better.

there any good reason to believe in the existence of

in materials?

Instead, we're going to ask a more fundamental question: is

different?

evidence for their existence. Why should souls be any

Most of us don't believe in fairies, there being no good

We're going to look at two different arguments for the

existence of souls.

explain the nature of consciousness.

The argument we are going to look at turns on

the idea that in materials are needed to